

film review Only Ishstyle

TASHAN

Director: Vijay Krishna Acharya
Starring: Akshay Kumar, Saif Ali Khan, Anil Kapoor, Kareena Kapoor

The opening seems promising. A red Mercedes alternately blaring AC/DC's *Highway to Hell* and *Kabhi Kabhie* swerves left and right, indicating presumably the clash of cultures. On the face of it, it's a wonderful premise—Indians want to learn English, wherever they are, whatever they do, and they adore those who provide it. Call centre Indian meets Kanpuriya hopeful and it's instant magic. Anil Kapoor's Bhaiyaji, delivering *Deewar*'s temple scene in Indian English—"My *gunaah ki punishment my mother not giving. My mother return me please*,"—sounds fun the



ALL POMP NO SHOW: A still from the movie *Tashan*

first few times. But after that, the novelty begins to pall, and all the references to *Jaane Bhi Do Yaaron* and *Kala Pathar* refuse to amuse. The window dressing is good, with Aki Narula's stylised (but increasingly repetitive) costumes. The lyrics sometimes border on the insanely extreme (*white white face dekhe, dil ka beating fast*) but the screenplay just doesn't hold. When Kareena

Kapoor drives a sword into Kapoor's stylish satin waistcoat, all artistically choreographed by Peter Hein, one can't wait to get out of the theatre. Not happy in my heart. *Dil* not dance *maare re*. Lesson to Yash Raj Films. Leave the *ganwar* gorillas and *gudiyas* of *Laaga Chunari Mein Daag*, *Aaja Nachle* and *Tashan*. Go back to Swiss lakes. You know un-reality better.

by Kaveree Bamzai

obituary Pure and Divine

Noted vocalist Shanti Sharma, 52, who carved a special place for herself in the world of classical music, passed away on April 22. An exponent of the Kirana Gharana, she got her initial training from Sangameshwar Gudur and later became one of the foremost disciples of Pandit Amarnath. Kathak guru Birju Maharaj described her as a naturally gifted and extremely melodious singer.

Coming from an army background, she was a product of BRS Pilani. "Music for me is a vocation, God's



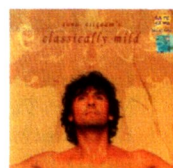
Shanti Sharma
1956–2008

gift, which I humbly accept and nurture," she would say. While other musicians dabbled in fusion, she believed in pure tradition. "I am strongly rooted to tradition. I do not believe in fusion," she had once remarked. She taught at the Shriram

Bharatiya Kala Kendra and co-composed the musical score for *Ram*, its flagship production. "She was one of the rarest musicians who had an amazing will to learn," says Biswajit Roy Chowdhry, sarod maestro and her colleague at the Kendra. "I am still evolving my own style of music, my *manzil* is to reach the heights of sublimity in singing," Sharma once said. But destiny played a cruel joke. Sharma died young. She jumped from the second floor of her home, while preparing for a recording. The classical diva will always be remembered for her short but creative life.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit

music reviews Perfect Melodies



Sa Re Ga Ma
Rs 125

SONU NIGAM: CLASSICALLY MILD

When Sonu Nigam started

learning the art of singing, he never focused on classical music. But later, he realised its beauty and importance. His album, which is a heartfelt tribute to Indian classical music, is based on semi-classical strains and has eight tracks that explore a spectrum of emotions—be it paying homage to a woman or an expression of loneliness. Nigam has embellished the album with his inimical style, taking the listener to a different plane. The mix of classical and western instruments lends a rare richness to the album, bringing to the fore another avatar of the singer.



Sa Re Ga Ma
Rs 150

K FOR KISHORE

"Kishore Kumar was a sam-poorana kalakar," melody

queen Lata Mangeshkar once remarked. True to the observation, this collection has a wide range which showcases his versatility, as seen in his scores such as *Nakhrewali* (New Delhi), *Roop tera mastana* (Aradhna) and *Aapke anurodh pe* (Anurodh). Kumar is still an integral part of reality shows on television today, where most contestants prefer to sing his tunes. What was amazing about his voice was that it could adapt to any score and any mood. That is what sets a legend apart. *K for Kishore* is a must for all Kishore fans.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit